CABLE TANK TOP

ENGLISH KNITTING PATTERN | WOMEN'S M & L | CHARTED TECHNICAL EDITION



Cover image is a styling illustration; texture details may differ slightly from the charted design. Work from the charts and written instructions.

SIZE	M	L
Finished chest after side seams	86.7 cm / 34.1 in	100 cm / 39.4 in
Body length	55.8 cm / 22.0 in	58.3 cm / 23.0 in
Washed gauge	18 sts × 24 rows = 10 cm / 4 in	Same gauge
Construction	Worked flat; seamed; bands in the round	Same

DESIGN REFERENCE Sleeveless cable tank with ribbed lower edge, ribbed neckline and armholes, central honeycomb texture, paired diamond cables, outer rope cables and seed-stitch side fields. Exact fit depends on washed gauge and yarn behaviour.

01 SIZE, MATERIALS AND GAUGE

Choose a size from the finished measurements, not from the M/L label alone: compare the finished chest with your bust measurement; the difference is the ease. The same 54-stitch cable panel is used in both sizes; size L gains width in the side fields.

Size notation. In the text, numbers are given as M (L), for example “CO 80 (92) sts”. Where only one number is given, it applies to both sizes. Tables give each size in its own column.

CHECKPOINT	M	L
Cast on, each body piece	80 sts	92 sts
Side fields / centre panel	13 + 54 + 13 sts	19 + 54 + 19 sts
Piece width before seam take-up	44.4 cm / 17.5 in	51.1 cm / 20.1 in
Finished chest after side seams	86.7 cm / 34.1 in	100 cm / 39.4 in
Body length	55.8 cm / 22.0 in	58.3 cm / 23.0 in
Armhole depth	20.0 cm / 7.9 in	21.7 cm / 8.5 in
Shoulder width, each side	18 sts / 10.0 cm / 3.9 in	22 sts / 12.2 cm / 4.8 in
Back neck width	28 sts / 15.6 cm / 6.1 in	32 sts / 17.8 cm / 7.0 in
Front neck depth, approx.	10.0 cm / 3.9 in	10.8 cm / 4.3 in

Lengths are measured before the shoulder bind-off row.

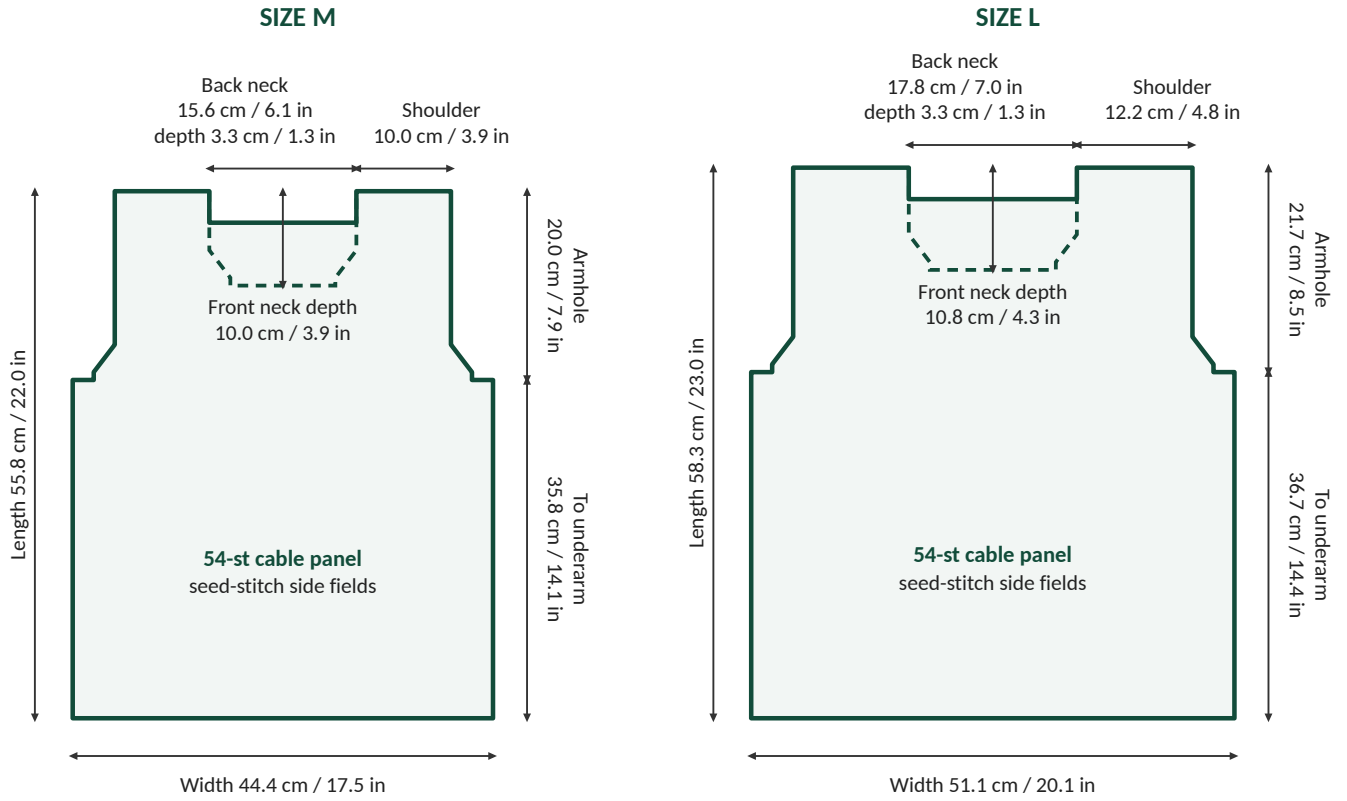
Materials

ITEM	M	L
Yarn	Approx. 900 m / 984 yd	Approx. 1050 m / 1148 yd
Yarn weight	Medium / worsted / Aran with clear cable definition	Same
Body needles	4.5 mm (US 7) straight or circular for working flat, or size needed for gauge	Same
Rib and band needles	4.0 mm (US 6) for cast-on and lower rib; 4.0 mm (US 6) 40 cm (16 in) circular, or DPNs / magic loop, for the bands	Same
Notions	Cable needle, 2 stitch markers plus 1 for the bands, stitch holders or scrap yarn, darning needle, tape measure	Same

Gauge – washed; do not skip

- 18 sts and 24 rows = 10 cm / 4 in over seed stitch and cable texture combined, on 4.5 mm (US 7) needles, after washing and drying flat.
- Work a generous swatch that includes cable texture and seed stitch. A plain stockinette swatch is not enough for this design. Wash and dry the swatch as you will treat the finished garment.
- Cable fabrics can contract differently from plain fabric. After the body has at least two full 16-row cable repeats, also check the actual piece width against the table above (44.4 (51.1) cm / 17.5 (20.1) in). If the piece is narrower or wider than the table, change needle size, not stitch counts.

02 CONSTRUCTION AND ROW MAP



Drawn to scale, both sizes at the same scale. Solid outline: back. Dashed line: front neckline (the front is otherwise identical to the back). Measurements are before bands.

Front and back are worked separately from the lower hem upward. Side seams and shoulder seams are sewn after blocking. Armhole and neckline ribs are then picked up and worked in the round.

Global rows and cable rows

Global row 1 is the first rib row (RS); all odd global rows are RS rows. The cable pattern begins on global row 13. Cable pattern row = ((global row − 13) mod 16) + 1. Keep the cable repeat running continuously through armhole shaping until a neckline removes part of a motif.

SHAPING POINT	M	L
Rib	Rows 1–12	Rows 1–12
Straight body	Rows 13–86	Rows 13–88
Armhole shaping	Rows 87–95	Rows 89–97
Front neck split	Row 111 (pattern row 3)	Row 115 (pattern row 7)
Back neck split	Row 127 (pattern row 3)	Row 133 (pattern row 9)
Shoulder bind-off	Row 135	Row 141

IMPORTANT Count global rows and cable-pattern rows separately. Shaping does not restart the 16-row cable repeat.

03 ABBREVIATIONS, CABLE SYMBOLS AND PANEL MAP

Abbreviations

approx.	approximately
BO	bind off
CO	cast on
cn	cable needle
dec	decrease (1 st)
DPNs	double-pointed needles
k	knit
k2tog	knit 2 sts together (1 st decreased, leans right)
p	purl
pm	place marker
rep	repeat
RS	right side
sm	slip marker
ssk	slip 2 sts knitwise one at a time, insert left needle into the front of both and knit them together (1 st decreased, leans left)
st(s)	stitch(es)
WS	wrong side
*	repeat the instructions after the * as directed
Seed st	k1, p1 alternately as set on the first row; on every following row knit the sts that look like purl bumps and purl the sts that look like knit Vs
cm, mm, m	centimetres, millimetres, metres
in, yd	inches, yards

Cable actions and chart key

Charts show the fabric as it looks from the right side. Chart columns are numbered from the right: column 1 is the rightmost cell, the first stitch worked on an RS row. Read RS chart rows (odd numbers, given at the right edge) from right to left, starting at column 1, and WS chart rows (even numbers, given at the left edge) from left to right. On WS rows, work stitches as they appear: knit a purl-bump stitch and purl a knit-V stitch. This preserves the RS texture.

SYMBOL	CODE	STS	EXACT ACTION
	k	1	Knit on RS, purl on WS.
	p	1	Purl on RS, knit on WS.
	C4F	4	Slip 2 sts to cn and hold in front; k2; k2 from cn.
	C4B	4	Slip 2 sts to cn and hold in back; k2; k2 from cn.
	C6F	6	Slip 3 sts to cn and hold in front; k3; k3 from cn.
	T3F	3	Slip 2 knit sts to cn and hold in front; p1; k2 from cn. Worked over K-K-P (in working order).
	T3B	3	Slip 1 purl st to cn and hold in back; k2; p1 from cn. Worked over P-K-K (in working order).
	Repeat		Red outline: rows 1–16 form the repeat; work them over and over.

A cable symbol covers all the cells of its stitches. Front crossings (C4F, C6F, T3F): the top strand runs from lower right to upper left. Back crossings (C4B, T3B): the top strand runs from lower left to upper right.

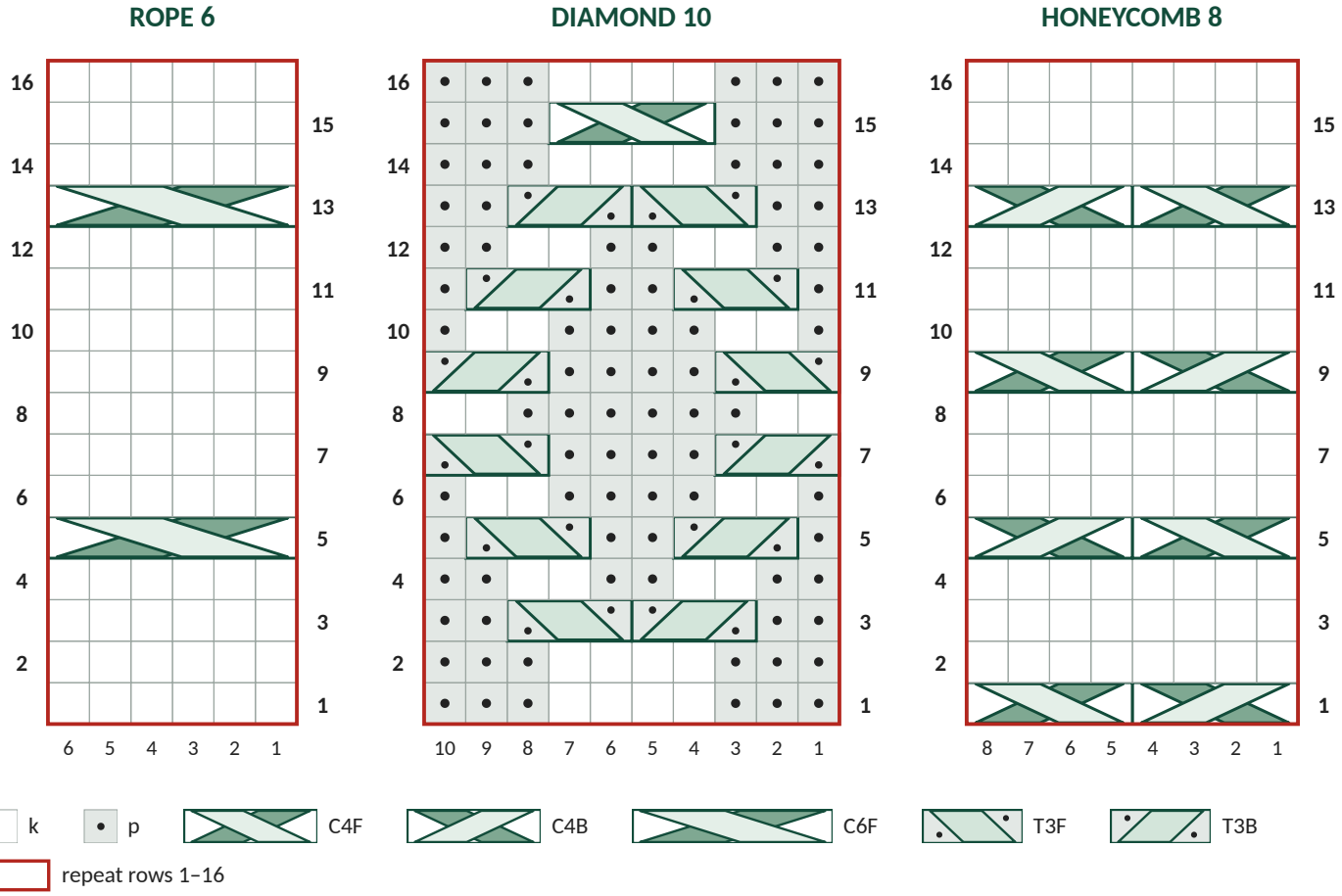
Panel map (as seen from the RS)

p3	**Rope 6**	p2	**Diamond 10**	p2	**Honeycomb 8**	p2	**Diamond 10**	p2	**Rope 6**	p3
3	6	2	10	2	8	2	10	2	6	3

Total centre panel = 54 stitches. The block layout is symmetrical; work the cables exactly as charted/written (cable directions are not mirrored). Keep markers exactly 54 stitches apart until neckline shaping cuts into the panel.

04 MOTIF CHARTS

16-row master repeat. Odd (RS) row numbers are at the right edge; read these rows from right to left, starting at column 1. Even (WS) row numbers are at the left edge; read these rows from left to right. Numbers under each chart are column numbers within the motif; column 1 is the rightmost cell.

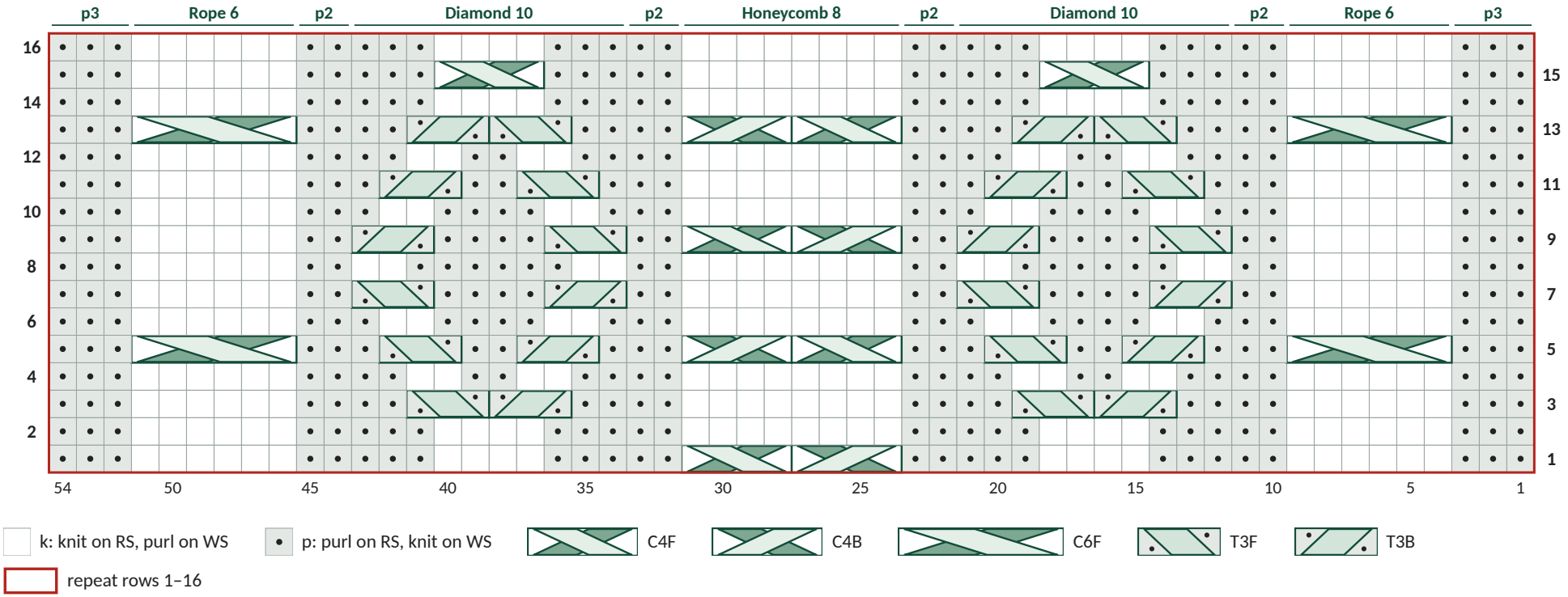


The Diamond 10 motif is a travelling-cable diamond. Its crossings are arranged so T3B is only worked across P-K-K and T3F only across K-K-P (in working order). This keeps the two knit strands travelling cleanly through a six-stitch purl background without changing the stitch count.

Rope 6 and Honeycomb 8 are all-knit cable fields on the RS; their WS rows are purled. Diamond background stitches remain purl on the RS and knit on the WS.

05 FULL 54-STITCH PANEL CHART

Charted as seen from the RS. Odd (RS) rows: numbers at the right; read right to left, starting at column 1. Even (WS) rows: numbers at the left; read left to right. Column numbers are shown below the chart; column 1 is the rightmost cell.



Place a marker before and after these 54 stitches. Repeat chart rows 1–16 continuously. The written directions on the next page match this chart row for row. Cable actions are defined in section 03.

06 WRITTEN 54-STITCH PANEL INSTRUCTIONS

On every RS row, work the panel in this fixed order: p3 | Rope 6 | p2 | Diamond 10 | p2 | Honeycomb 8 | p2 | Diamond 10 | p2 | Rope 6 | p3. Each Rope and each Diamond is worked exactly as given in its column.

PATTERN ROW (RS)	ROPE 6 – EACH	DIAMOND 10 – EACH	HONEYCOMB 8
1	k6	p3, k4, p3	C4B, C4F
3	k6	p2, T3B, T3F, p2	k8
5	C6F	p1, T3B, p2, T3F, p1	C4F, C4B
7	k6	T3B, p4, T3F	k8
9	k6	T3F, p4, T3B	C4B, C4F
11	k6	p1, T3F, p2, T3B, p1	k8
13	C6F	p2, T3F, T3B, p2	C4F, C4B
15	k6	p3, C4F, p3	k8

Example – pattern row 1 written out: p3, k6, p2, p3, k4, p3, p2, C4B, C4F, p2, p3, k4, p3, p2, k6, p3 (54 sts).

Even pattern rows 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14 and 16 (WS)

Work stitches exactly as they appear on the WS: knit the stitches that look like purl bumps and purl the stitches that look like knit Vs. In practical terms, Rope and Honeycomb are purled across on WS rows; Diamond knit strands are purled and its purl background is knitted. The 54-st count does not change on any row.

NECKLINE RULE Never work a cable crossing unless all stitches required for that crossing are still present. From the neck split row on (including the split row), work any Diamond that has lost stitches in its knit/purl texture without crossings. Rope cables stay complete and are crossed normally.

07 HEM AND STRAIGHT BODY – FRONT AND BACK

Front and back are worked the same way except for the first rib row and the set-up of the seed fields, given separately below.

Rows 1–12: lower rib

With 4.0 mm (US 6) needles, CO 80 (92) sts.

- **Front, row 1 (RS):** *k2, p2; rep from * to end.
- **Back, row 1 (RS):** *p2, k2; rep from * to end.
- **Both pieces, rows 2–12:** work the rib as established – knit the knit stitches and purl the purl stitches as they appear. Do not alternate the rib sequence by row.

The front and back start the rib differently so that, after one stitch from each piece is taken into each side seam, the k2, p2 rib runs continuously around the body. Checkpoint: 80 (92) sts.

Row 13 (RS): establish the body pattern

Change to 4.5 mm (US 7) needles. Work panel row 1 from the chart (section 05) or the written instructions (section 06). The seed fields are listed in working order: “first field” is worked at the start of the RS row, “second field” after the panel.

PIECE	SIZE	ROW START – PANEL – ROW END	TOTAL
Front	M	k1 (selvedge), (k1, p1) 6 times, pm, panel row 1 over 54 sts, pm, (p1, k1) 6 times, k1 (selvedge)	80 sts
Front	L	k1 (selvedge), (k1, p1) 9 times, pm, panel row 1 over 54 sts, pm, (p1, k1) 9 times, k1 (selvedge)	92 sts
Back	M	k1 (selvedge), (p1, k1) 6 times, pm, panel row 1 over 54 sts, pm, (k1, p1) 6 times, k1 (selvedge)	80 sts
Back	L	k1 (selvedge), (p1, k1) 9 times, pm, panel row 1 over 54 sts, pm, (k1, p1) 9 times, k1 (selvedge)	92 sts

Seed-stitch side fields

- The first and second fields are mirror images of each other, so the texture is mirrored at the panel edges. Front and back fields are set up opposite to each other so the seed stitch also continues unbroken across the side seams.
- **Row 14 (WS) and all following rows:** p1 (selvedge), work seed st to marker by working the opposite of the stitch you see (purl a knit V, knit a purl bump), sm, work the next panel row, sm, seed st to last st, p1 (selvedge). On RS rows, the selvedge sts are k1. The selvedge sts are always worked in stockinette (knit on RS, purl on WS).
- Keep the two panel markers 54 stitches apart. Armhole shaping removes only side-field stitches, so the cable panel remains intact until neckline shaping.

Work straight

Continue in pattern as set through global row 86 (88) – this is pattern row 10 (12), a WS row. 80 (92) sts remain.

Length check: the piece now measures approx. 35.8 (36.7) cm / 14.1 (14.4) in from the CO edge, measured flat. Work by the row numbers, not by length: the row numbers set the cable phase for the shaping. If your row gauge differs from 24 rows per 10 cm, the length to the underarm (and the total length) will differ in proportion.

CHECKPOINT Before beginning armholes, verify the total stitch count, 80 (92) sts; 54 stitches between the panel markers; 13 (19) sts outside each marker (including the selvedge st); and the cable-pattern row phase (last row worked = pattern row 10 (12)).

08 BACK – ARMHOLES, NECK AND SHOULDERS

Continue the cable panel and seed fields as set throughout. Work the back first or second; it is shaped as follows.

ACTION	M	L
First armhole row, RS	Row 87: BO 4 at row start, work to end – 76 sts	Row 89: BO 4 at row start, work to end – 88 sts
Next row, WS	Row 88: BO 4 at row start, work to end – 72 sts	Row 90: BO 4 at row start, work to end – 84 sts
4 RS decrease rows	Rows 89, 91, 93, 95: dec 1 at EACH edge → 70, 68, 66, 64 sts	Rows 91, 93, 95, 97: dec 1 at EACH edge → 82, 80, 78, 76 sts
Work even	Rows 96–126 on 64 sts	Rows 98–132 on 76 sts
Back neck split, RS	Row 127: work 18 sts and slip them to a holder; BO the next 28 sts; work to end – 18 sts	Row 133: work 22 sts and slip them to a holder; BO the next 32 sts; work to end – 22 sts
Shoulders	Work each shoulder through row 134; BO 18 sts on row 135	Work each shoulder through row 140; BO 22 sts on row 141

Armhole bind-offs

On each BO row, bind off 4 sts in pattern; the stitch on the right needle after the last BO counts as the first stitch of the rest of the row. From now on the new edge stitch at each armhole is a selvedge stitch: knit on RS, purl on WS.

Armhole decreases

On each listed RS decrease row: k1, ssk; maintain the remaining seed field; work the complete 54-st panel; maintain the opposite seed field to the last 3 sts; k2tog, k1. Each decrease row removes exactly 2 stitches. Work every WS row in between without decreases (p1, pattern to last st, p1). Checkpoint after the last decrease: 64 (76) sts – 54 panel sts and 5 (11) sts outside each marker.

Back neck split

On row 127 (133): work 18 (22) sts and slip them to a holder; BO the next 28 (32) sts in pattern without crossings (the st on the right needle after the last BO counts as the first of the remaining sts); work to end – 18 (22) sts. Checkpoint: 18 (22) / 28 (32) bound off / 18 (22).

Working the two back shoulders

After the centre neck bind-off, continue the second shoulder first (the sts on the needle). Work its next row as the required WS row (row 128 (134)) and continue to the final WS row 134 (140), then bind off all 18 (22) sts in pattern on RS row 135 (141). Rejoin yarn with WS facing at the neck edge of the held first shoulder and work the same row numbers so both shoulder tops finish at exactly the same height.

PARTIAL MOTIFS Size M only: 2 sts of each Diamond remain on each back shoulder. Work these remaining stitches in their established knit/purl texture, without crossings, until the shoulder bind-off. Size L: the back-neck BO removes both Diamonds completely; no partial motif remains.

09 FRONT – NECKLINE AND SHOULDERS

Work the front exactly as the back through completion of armhole shaping. The front neckline starts earlier.

ACTION	M	L
After armhole shaping	64 sts after row 95	76 sts after row 97
Work even	Rows 96–110	Rows 98–114
Front neck split, RS	Row 111: work 22 sts and slip them to a holder; BO the next 20 sts; work to end – 22 sts	Row 115: work 26 sts and slip them to a holder; BO the next 24 sts; work to end – 26 sts
Neck decreases	Rows 113, 115, 117, 119: dec 1 at neck edge → 21, 20, 19, 18 sts	Rows 117, 119, 121, 123: dec 1 at neck edge → 25, 24, 23, 22 sts
Finish	Keep 18 sts through row 134; BO row 135	Keep 22 sts through row 140; BO row 141

Front neck split

On row 111 (115): work 22 (26) sts and slip them to a holder; BO the next 20 (24) sts in pattern without crossings (the st on the right needle after the last BO counts as the first of the remaining sts); work to end – 22 (26) sts. Checkpoint: 22 (26) / 20 (24) bound off / 22 (26).

Mirror-image neck decreases

- **Second shoulder** (the sts on the needle, worked first): work row 112 (116) (WS). Its RS rows begin at the neckline. On each listed RS row work k1, ssk, then continue in established pattern to the outer edge.
- **First shoulder** (held before the centre BO): rejoin yarn with WS facing at the neckline for row 112 (116). On each listed RS row, work from the outer edge to the last 3 sts, then k2tog, k1.
- Work all WS rows in between without a decrease. Stop after the fourth neck decrease. Checkpoint: 18 (22) sts on each shoulder.
- Work each shoulder straight through row 134 (140), then BO all sts in pattern on row 135 (141), so front and back shoulders match in row number and stitch count.

CABLES AT THE FRONT NECK From the split row on (including the split row), work any Diamond that has lost stitches in its knit/purl texture without crossings. Rope cables stay complete and are crossed normally. Size M: 2 Diamond sts remain on each shoulder after the neck decreases. Size L: the neck decreases remove the cut Diamond completely.

10 FINISHING AND RIBBED BANDS

Blocking and seams

- Wet-block front and back separately to the target measurements (section 01). Let both pieces dry completely before seaming.
- Sew shoulder bound-off edges with a firm backstitch seam, right sides together. Match the front and back shoulder row ends exactly.
- Sew side seams with mattress stitch, one full stitch in from the edge. Match global rows so the cable columns and lower rib remain level. With one stitch from each piece taken into each seam, the lower rib and the seed stitch run continuously across both side seams.

Armhole bands

	M	L
Target pickup	80 sts around EACH armhole	88 sts around EACH armhole
Guide per half	4 sts across underarm BO + about 36 along shaped/vertical edge	4 sts across underarm BO + about 40 along shaped/vertical edge

With RS facing and the 4.0 mm (US 6) 40 cm (16 in) circular needle (or DPNs / magic loop), begin at the underarm seam. Pick up the first half to the shoulder seam and mirror it on the second half. Pm for the beginning of the round and join to work in the round. Confirm the total, 80 (88) sts, before knitting the rib.

Neckline band

	M – 92 STS TOTAL	L – 104 STS TOTAL
Horizontal edges	Back 28 + front centre 20	Back 32 + front centre 24
Shaped/vertical edges	5 along each back-neck side + 17 along each front-neck slope	5 along each back-neck side + 19 along each front-neck slope

With RS facing and the 4.0 mm (US 6) circular needle, begin at the left shoulder seam (as worn) and pick up 17 (19) sts down the left front-neck slope, 20 (24) sts across the front centre BO, 17 (19) sts up the right front-neck slope, 5 sts down the right back-neck side, 28 (32) sts across the back neck BO and 5 sts up the left back-neck side – 92 (104) sts. Pm and join to work in the round.

Horizontal bound-off edges are picked up approximately 1 stitch per bound-off stitch. Along row-end edges pick up slightly fewer than 3 sts for every 4 rows, as given in the table, so the band sits snugly. The totals are multiples of 4 for the 2×2 rib.

Ribbing

For both armholes and the neckline: work 6 rounds of *k2, p2; rep from * around. Bind off loosely in rib pattern. If a band visibly pulls inward or flares after a trial round, redistribute the pickups and adjust the total by a multiple of 4 rather than forcing the edge flat during blocking.

Final finishing

- Weave in all ends on the WS, along the seams where possible.
- Lightly steam or wet-block the bands so they lie flat; let the garment dry flat.

11 QUALITY-CONTROL CHECKLIST

CHECKPOINT	M TARGET	L TARGET
After rib, global row 12	80 sts	92 sts
After both underarm BO rows	72 sts at row 88	84 sts at row 90
After last armhole decrease	64 sts at row 95	76 sts at row 97
Front immediately after neck split	22 / 20 BO / 22	26 / 24 BO / 26
Front after 4 neck decreases	18 each shoulder	22 each shoulder
Back immediately after neck split	18 / 28 BO / 18	22 / 32 BO / 22
Armhole pickup target	80 per opening	88 per opening
Neckline pickup target	92 total	104 total

Cable audit checkpoints

- Every centre panel row uses exactly 54 stitches. Cable crossings rearrange stitches but never increase or decrease the panel count.
- Diamond 10 always contains four travelling knit stitches and six purl-background stitches. T3B must meet P-K-K; T3F must meet K-K-P (in working order). If that setup is not present, stop and correct the previous cable row.
- Rope 6 and Honeycomb 8 contain only knit stitches on the RS. On WS rows these fields are purled.
- Front and back shoulder counts and final row numbers must match before seaming: M = 18 sts and row 135; L = 22 sts and row 141.

Problem solving

- Cable panel count is wrong: undo to the last incorrect crossing. Do not repair a cable-count problem by adding an unlisted increase.
- Front and back do not align: compare global row number and cable-repeat phase before seaming.
- Finished garment is too narrow or wide: compare the washed gauge and actual piece width with section 01; if they differ, change needle size rather than stitch counts.
- Rib band ripples or pulls: redistribute pickup spacing and, if necessary, change the total by a multiple of 4.

SUPPORT If a step is unclear, message the seller with the size, section title, global row number, current stitch count and a clear photo of the work. This makes troubleshooting much faster.

PERSONAL USE: Finished garments may be sold in small quantities. Please do not redistribute, translate, share or resell the PDF instructions.